

THE UNIVERSAL HOUSE OF JUSTICE

1998-07-02

To all National Spiritual Assemblies

1 dearly loved friends,

**T wenty-five years have now elapsed since the establishment of the
international Teaching center announced in our message of 5 june**

2 1973.275-1 These years have seen the progressive unfoldment of the duties of

3 this cardinal institution of the cause of god, and the development of its

4 the continental boards of counselors on the other. during the five years

5 just completed, it exercised increased responsibility in relation to the protec-tion of
the faith. it stimulated pioneering and travel-teaching, as well as

6 the production and distribution of literature and audiovisual aids and, after the
launching of the four year plan, it imparted a fundamental impetus to

7 the establishment and sound functioning of training institutes. Suffusing all these
activities has been its continuous interaction with the continental

8 boards of counselors, through whom its influence and encouragement have

9 reached all levels and every area of the bahá'í world community.

on 23 may 1998 the international Teaching center entered upon a five-

10 year period full of promise for the speedy advancement of the process of entry by
troops into the cause of bahá'u'lláh. on the morning of Saturday

13 june, the newly appointed members having arrived from their far-flung

14 homelands, all the counselor members of the Teaching center met in bahjí

with the hands of the cause of god Amatu'l-b ahá rú'yyih khánúm and

15 prayer at the Sacred Threshold of the Shrine of bahá'u'lláh. There followed

16 a week of intense consultation and preparation for the next phase of their

17 work, focused on the prosecution of the second half of the f our y ear p lan.

18 it is our ardent prayer in the holy Shrines that as the edifices which are

19 the Seats of the institutions of the faith at its world center rise before

20 the public gaze on the slope of mount carmel, and the influence of the

21 275-1. muhj, no. 131.275.1
275 2
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276 m e S S a g e S f r o m T h e u n i v e r S a l h o u S e o f j u S T i c e
277 62institutions of its Administrative order becomes more potent in every land,
278 so the ears of mankind will become attuned to the glorious message which
279 the devoted followers of bahá'u'lláh are proclaiming and, on every side, the
280 spiritually thirsty masses will rally to h is banner.
281 with loving b ahá'í greetings,
282 276

Execution of Bahá'í in Iran

[signed: The Universal House of Justice]